

Word family: **point / points / pointed / pointing / pointer / pointless / pointlessly / viewpoint**

Base word: point

Plural: points

Past tense: pointed

Past participle: pointed

-ing form: pointing

Related forms: pointer, pointless, pointlessly, pointed, viewpoint

Useful constructions/extensions: turning point, point in time, at this point, reach a point, main point, point of something, make a point, prove a point, point of view, standpoint/viewpoint, point at/to, point out, point toward, score points, percentage point, decimal point, boiling/freezing point, sharp point, beside the point, to the point, get to the point, no point in, point taken

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / related adjective and noun forms (相關形容詞及名詞)

Your passage contains:

> “However, looking back, it was a **turning point** for me.”

Here, **point** means:

a particular stage or moment in a process at which an important change begins.

Meaning in this passage

In:

> **a turning point**

point means:

a particular moment or stage in your experience at which the direction of your development changed significantly.

Before the presentation:

- * you regularly feared public speaking;
- * you wanted to avoid opportunities like this;
- * speaking English to a large audience felt like a brick wall.

Afterwards:

- * you had proved that you could do it;
- * your attitude began to change;

* you still felt nervous, but no longer saw presentations as impossible.

So this event became a **point** in your personal development where the direction changed.

Meaning: A particular moment or stage in a process, especially one that marks an important change.

繁體中文： 某個過程中的特定時刻 / 階段；這裡指令事情發展方向出現重大改變的關鍵時刻

中文翻譯：

> “Looking back, it was a turning point for me.”

「現在回想起來，那是我人生 / 成長中的一個**轉捩點**。」

So:

turning point = 轉捩點 / 重大轉變的關鍵時刻

This is the exact passage meaning.

1. **point** = particular moment/stage (時刻 / 階段) — 某個時點；階段

This is the core sense underlying your passage.

Meaning: A particular position or stage in time, progress, development, or a process.

Practice 1

> “At that **point**, I was still extremely nervous.”

「在那個**時候 / 階段**，我仍然非常緊張。」

Practice 2

> “We reached a **point** where we had to make a decision.”

「我們來到了一個必須作決定的**階段**。」

point = 某個過程、時間或發展中的特定位置 / 階段

2. **turning point (轉捩點) — 重大轉變的關鍵時刻**

This is the exact construction in your passage.

Practice 2 — Original

> “It was a **turning point** for me.”

「那是我的一個**轉捩點**。」

Practice 3

> “Giving that presentation became a **turning point** in her career.”

「那次簡報成為她職業生涯中的一個**轉捩點**。」

Practice 4

> “The experience marked a major **turning point** in his confidence.”

「這次經歷標誌著他自信心的一個重大**轉折點**。」

turning point = 某件事情開始明顯改變方向、狀況或發展軌跡的關鍵時刻 / 事件

3. **point in time (時間點) — 某一時刻**

Practice 5

> “At that **point in time**, I had little experience.”

「在那個**時間點**，我幾乎沒有經驗。」

Practice 6

> “We cannot know exactly what happened at every **point in time**.”

「我們不可能知道每一個**時間點**發生了甚麼。」

point in time = 時間線上的某一個特定時刻

4. **at this/that point (到了這 / 那個時候) — 此時；當時；到那階段**

Practice 7

> “At that **point**, I decided to keep going.”

「到了那個**時候 / 階段**，我決定繼續下去。」

Practice 8

> “At this **point**, we have enough information.”

「到了**這個階段**，我們已有足夠資料。」

at this/that point = 在某個特定時間或發展階段

5. **reach a point where...** (到了.....的地步 / 階段) — 到達某階段

Practice 9

> “I reached a **point where** I could no longer avoid public speaking.”

「我到了**不能再逃避公開演講的階段**。」

Practice 10

> “The discussion reached a **point where** no one could agree.”

「討論發展到了一個**大家無法達成共識的地步**。」

reach a point where = 情況發展到某個具有重要結果 / 改變的階段

6. **to the point where...** (到了.....程度) — 到了.....地步

Practice 11

> “I became nervous to the **point where** I could barely speak.”

「我緊張到**幾乎說不出話的程度**。」

Practice 12

> “The problem worsened to the **point where** action was necessary.”

「問題惡化到**必須採取行動的地步**。」

to the point where = 某種情況達到足以引起另一結果的程度

7. **point** = main idea (要點 / 重點) — 重點 ; 要點

A major abstract noun sense.

Meaning: The main idea, argument, or message that someone wants others to understand.

Practice 13

> “The main **point** of the presentation was clear.”

「簡報的主要**重點**很清楚。」

Practice 14

> “I understand your **point**.”

「我明白你的**意思 / 觀點**。」

point = 說話、文章、論證等希望傳達的主要意思 / 重點

8. **main/key point** (主要 / 關鍵重點) — 重點 ; 要點

Practice 15

> “Focus on three **key points**.”

「集中講三個**重點**。」

Practice 16

> “The **main point** is that preparation builds confidence.”

「**主要重點**是充分準備能建立自信。」

key/main point = 一段內容中最重要、最值得記住的資訊 / 論點

9. ****make a point (提出觀點) — 提出一點；表達觀點****

Practice 17

> “She made an important ****point**** about preparation.”

「她就準備工作提出了一個重要****觀點****。」

Practice 18

> “I’d like to make one ****point****.”

「我想提出一個****重點 / 觀點****。」

****make a point = 清楚提出一項意見、理由或重要資訊****

10. ****make the point that... (強調 / 提出.....這一點) — 指出；強調****

Practice 19

> “She made the ****point that**** mistakes are normal.”

「她****指出 / 強調****犯錯是正常的。」

Practice 20

> “The speaker made the ****point that**** clarity matters more than complexity.”

「講者****指出****清晰比複雜更重要。」

****make the point that = 明確表達並強調某項重要看法****

11. ****get the point (明白重點 / 意思) — 明白；懂了****

Practice 21

> “I ****get the point****.”

「我****明白你的意思了****。」

Practice 22

> “Do you **get my point**?”

「你**明白我的重點 / 意思嗎**？」

get the point = 理解對方真正想表達的主要意思

12. **miss the point** (沒抓住重點) — 誤解重點；沒有明白

Practice 23

> “You’re **missing the point**.”

「你**沒有抓到重點**。」

Practice 24

> “The criticism completely **misses the point**.”

「這項批評完全**沒有理解真正重點**。」

miss the point = 未能理解某段話 / 事情最重要的真正意思

13. **get to the point** (說到重點) — 直入主題；說重點

Practice 25

> “Please **get to the point**.”

「請**直接說重點**。」

Practice 26

> “She quickly **got to the point**.”

「她很快就**說到重點**。」

get to the point = 不再講不必要內容，直接說最重要的事情

14. **to the point** (切中要點的) — 切題；簡明直接

Practice 27

> “Her answer was brief and ****to the point****.”

「她的回答簡短而且****切中要點****。」

Practice 28

> “Keep your presentation clear and ****to the point****.”

「簡報要清晰而且****直截了當、切題****。」

****to the point = 直接相關、沒有多餘內容，而且集中於主要問題****

15. ****beside the point (與重點無關) — 離題；不重要****

Practice 29

> “Whether he was nervous is ****beside the point****.”

「他是否緊張其實****不是重點 / 與問題無關****。」

Practice 30

> “That argument is ****beside the point****.”

「那個論點****離題了 / 與真正問題無關****。」

****beside the point = 與正在討論的真正問題 / 重點無關****

16. ****point = purpose/reason (意義 / 目的) — 目的；意義****

A major separate abstract sense.

Practice 31

> “What is the ****point**** of practising if you never review your mistakes?”

「如果你從不檢討錯誤，那練習有甚麼****意義 / 目的****？」

Practice 32

> “The **point** of the exercise is to build confidence.”

「這項練習的**目的**是建立自信。」

the point of something = 某件事存在 / 進行的主要目的、價值或理由

17. **What's the point?** (有甚麼意義？) — 有甚麼用？

Practice 33

> “What's the **point** of worrying about a tiny mistake?”

「為一個小錯擔心有甚麼**用 / 意義**？」

Practice 34

> “If nobody listens, what's the **point**?”

「如果沒有人聽，那有甚麼**意義**？」

What's the point? = 質疑某件事是否有實際目的、價值或好處

18. **there is no point in + -ing** (做.....沒有意義) — 沒有必要 / 沒有用

A very common construction.

Practice 35

> “There's no **point in worrying** about every mistake.”

「為每個錯誤擔心都**沒有意義 / 沒有必要**。」

Practice 36

> “There's no **point in pretending** to understand.”

「假裝明白是**沒有用的**。」

there is no point in doing = 做某事不會帶來有用結果，因此沒有意義 / 必要

Important grammar:

>  no point in **worrying**

not:

>  no point to worry

19. **point** = argument/reason (論點 / 理由) — 道理 ; 理由

Practice 37

> “You have a good **point**.”

「你說得**有道理**。」

Practice 38

> “That’s a fair **point**.”

「那是一個合理的**觀點 / 理由**。」

point = 支持某種看法的一項有道理的意見 / 理由

20. **You have a point** (你說得有道理) — 有道理

Practice 39

> “You have a **point**—the audience may prefer simpler language.”

「你**說得有道理**——觀眾可能較喜歡簡單的語言。」

Practice 40

> “She has a **point** about the timing.”

「她對時間控制的看法**有道理**。」

have a point = 某人的意見至少有合理 / 值得考慮之處

21. **point taken** (明白你的道理了) — 明白 ; 接受這一點

A common conversational expression.

Practice 41

> “You need more practice.”

> “**Point taken.**”

「你需要更多練習。」

「**明白，你說得有道理。**」

Practice 42

> “That example is too technical.”

> “**Point taken.**”

「那個例子太技術性了。」

「**收到 / 明白你的意思。**」

point taken = 表示理解並接受對方提出的批評、理由或觀點

22. **prove a point (證明自己的觀點) — 證明一點 / 論點**

Practice 43

> “He repeated the experiment to **prove a point**.”

「他重做實驗來**證明自己的論點**。」

Practice 44

> “You don’t need to take unnecessary risks just to **prove a point**.”

「你不需要只是為了**證明自己是對的**而冒不必要的風險。」

prove a point = 提供證據 / 行動來顯示某個主張是正確的

23. **make a point of doing something (特意做某事) — 特別注意 ; 刻意**

A very important idiom distinct from ordinary ****make a point****.

Practice 45

> “I ****make a point of arriving early****.”

「我會****特意 / 一向堅持提早到達****。」

Practice 46

> “She makes a ****point of thanking**** everyone.”

「她總會****特意向每個人道謝****。」

****make a point of doing** = 認為某件事很重要，所以刻意 / 有意識地確保自己去做******

24. ****point = viewpoint/opinion (觀點) — 觀點；立場****

Often appears in ****point of view****.

Practice 47

> “I understand your ****point of view****.”

「我明白你的****觀點 / 立場****。」

Practice 48

> “Try to see the issue from the audience’s ****point of view****.”

「試著從觀眾的****角度****看問題。」

****point of view** = 某人理解、看待或判斷事情的角度 / 立場******

25. ****from someone’s point of view (從某人角度) — 從.....角度看****

Practice 49

> “From my ****point of view****, the presentation was worthwhile.”

「****從我的角度看****，這次簡報很值得。」

Practice 50

> “From the manager’s **point of view**, preparation was essential.”

「**從經理的角度看**，準備工作非常重要。」

from X’s point of view = 站在某人的立場 / 角度來理解某件事

26. **viewpoint** (觀點 / 立場) — 觀點；看法

A useful related lexical extension.

Practice 51

> “We should consider different **viewpoints**.”

「我們應該考慮不同的**觀點**。」

Practice 52

> “Her **viewpoint** changed after the experience.”

「那次經歷後，她的**看法**改變了。」

viewpoint = 某人看待某個問題的特定角度、立場或意見

27. **point** = exact place/location (點 / 位置) — 地點；位置

A major spatial sense.

Practice 53

> “Meet me at this **point** on the map.”

「在地圖上的這個**位置**跟我會合。」

Practice 54

> “The road is narrow at this **point**.”

「道路在這個**位置**很窄。」

****point = 空間中一個特定而精確的位置****

28. ****starting/end point (起點 / 終點) — 起點 ; 終點****

Practice 55

> “This building is our ****starting point****.”

「這座建築是我們的****起點****。」

Practice 56

> “The station is the ****end point**** of the route.”

「車站是路線的****終點****。」

****point = 路線 / 過程上的特定位置****

29. ****meeting point (集合點) — 集合地點****

Practice 57

> “The lobby is our ****meeting point****.”

「大堂是我們的****集合點****。」

Practice 58

> “Choose an easy-to-find ****meeting point****.”

「選一個容易找到的****集合地點****。」

****meeting point = 大家約定集合的指定位置****

30. ****point = small dot/mark (點) — 點 ; 小圓點****

A physical/graphic sense.

Practice 59

> “Mark the location with a **point**.”

「用一個**點**標記位置。」

Practice 60

> “The diagram contains several coloured **points**.”

「圖表包含幾個彩色**點**。」

point = 很小的圓點 / 標記，常代表一個位置或數據值

31. **data point** (數據點) — 數據點；單項數據

Practice 61

> “One **data point** is not enough to show a trend.”

「一個**數據點**不足以顯示趨勢。」

Practice 62

> “Each dot represents a **data point**.”

「每個圓點代表一個**數據點**。」

data point = 資料集中一個個別觀察值 / 測量值

32. **point** = sharp end/tip (尖端) — 尖端；尖頭

A major physical noun sense.

Practice 63

> “The pencil has a sharp **point**.”

「鉛筆有一個尖銳的**筆尖**。」

Practice 64

> “Be careful with the **point** of the knife.”

「小心刀的**尖端**。」

****point = 物件逐漸收窄形成的尖銳末端****

33. ****point of a needle/pencil (針尖 / 筆尖) — 尖端****

Practice 65

> “The ****point of the needle**** is extremely sharp.”

「****針尖****非常鋒利。」

Practice 66

> “The pencil ****point**** broke.”

「鉛筆****筆尖****斷了。」

****point = 細長物件最尖的末端****

34. ****point = projecting piece of land (岬角 / 地點名稱用法) — 岬 ; 突出地形****

A geographical sense.

Practice 67

> “They walked out to the ****point****.”

「他們走到突出的****岬角****。」

Practice 68

> “The lighthouse stands on the rocky ****point****.”

「燈塔建在岩石****岬角****上。」

****point = 向水域 / 外部突出的狹長陸地部分****

Lower priority but established.

35. **point** = score/unit in games/tests (分數) — 分 ; 點

A major everyday sense.

Practice 69

> “The team won by three **points**.”

「球隊以三**分**之差勝出。」

Practice 70

> “Each question is worth five **points**.”

「每題值五**分**。」

point = 比賽、考試、評分制度中用來計算成績的一個單位

36. **score/earn/get points** (得分) — 得分 ; 取得分數

Practice 71

> “She scored ten **points**.”

「她取得十分。」

Practice 72

> “You get extra **points** for clarity.”

「表達清晰可以獲得額外**分數**。」

points = 評分 / 比賽中的計量單位

37. **percentage point** (百分點) — 百分點

A very important statistical distinction.

Practice 73

> “The rate rose from 5% to 7%, an increase of two **percentage points**.”

「比率由 5% 升至 7% , 增加兩個**百分點**。」

Practice 74

> “Support fell by three **percentage points**.”

「支持率下降三個**百分點**。」

****percentage point = 兩個百分比數值之間的直接差距單位****

This is not the same as:

> percent change.

38. ****decimal point (小數點) — 小數點****

Practice 75

> “Put the **decimal point** in the correct place.”

「把**小數點**放在正確位置。」

Practice 76

> “3.5 contains a **decimal point**.”

「3.5 中有一個**小數點**。」

****decimal point = 用來分隔整數部分和小數部分的點號****

39. ****point = temperature/stage threshold (臨界點) — 點 ; 臨界溫度****

A major scientific/general sense.

Practice 77

> “Water reaches its boiling **point** at about 100°C under standard atmospheric pressure.”

「在標準大氣壓下 , 水的**沸點**約為 100°C。」

Practice 78

> “The temperature fell below freezing **point**.”

「溫度跌至**冰點**以下。」

point = 某個物理 / 化學變化發生的特定臨界值

40. **boiling/freezing/melting point** (沸點 / 冰點 / 熔點) — 臨界溫度

Practice 79

> “Ice has a specific **melting point**.”

「冰有特定的**熔點**。」

Practice 80

> “The liquid has a low **boiling point**.”

「這種液體的**沸點**較低。」

X point = 某種狀態轉變發生的特定溫度 / 條件

41. **breaking point** (極限) — 崩潰點；承受極限

A common figurative expression.

Practice 81

> “The stress pushed him to **breaking point**.”

「壓力令他到了**承受極限 / 快要崩潰的程度**。」

Practice 82

> “The system was close to **breaking point**.”

「系統接近**崩潰極限**。」

breaking point = 人 / 系統再也難以承受額外壓力的極限程度

42. **boiling point figuratively** (怒氣爆發點) — 忍耐極限

Practice 83

> “Tension reached **boiling point**.”

「緊張局勢達到**爆發點**。」

Practice 84

> “His anger was approaching **boiling point**.”

「他的怒氣快到**爆發邊緣**。」

boiling point = 比喻情緒 / 局勢即將失控的臨界程度

43. **point = feature/aspect** (特點) — 特點 ; 方面

Practice 85

> “Confidence is one of her strong **points**.”

「自信是她其中一個**優點 / 長處**。」

Practice 86

> “The report has several weak **points**.”

「這份報告有幾個**弱點**。」

point = 某人 / 某物可被個別識別和評價的一項特徵

44. **strong/weak point** (強項 / 弱點) — 優點 ; 弱點

Practice 87

> “Clear communication is her strongest **point**.”

「清晰溝通是她最大的**強項**。」

Practice 88

> “Timing was my weak **point**.”

「時間控制是我的**弱項**。」

strong/weak point = 某人 / 事物特別擅長 / 不足的一個方面

45. **selling point** (賣點) — 賣點 ; 吸引之處

A major business expression.

Practice 89

> “Simplicity is the product’s main **selling point**.”

「簡單易用是這產品的主要**賣點**。」

Practice 90

> “The location is a strong **selling point**.”

「地點是很大的**吸引點 / 賣點**。」

selling point = 令產品、服務或想法特別有吸引力 / 值得選擇的優點

46. **point** = electrical socket/outlet (插座 / 接點 ; 英式) — 插座 ; 接點

A domain/regional sense.

Practice 91

> “There is a power **point** beside the desk.”

「桌旁有一個電源**插座**。」

Practice 92

> “Plug the projector into that **point**.”

「把投影機插進那個電源**插座**。」

power point = 電力連接位置 / 插座

Especially British/Australian English.

Do not confuse this generic term with the software name **PowerPoint**.

47. **point** = compass direction (羅盤方位點) — 方位點

A specialized but established sense.

Practice 93

> “North is one of the main compass **points**.”

「北方是主要羅盤方位之一。」

Practice 94

> “The compass shows the cardinal **points**.”

「指南針顯示主要方位。」

compass point = 指南針上的方向位置

48. **point** = verb: indicate with finger/object (指) — 指著；指向

Now **point** is a verb.

Meaning: To direct a finger, hand, or object toward someone/something to indicate it.

Practice 95

> “She **pointed at** the first slide.”

「她指著第一張投影片。」

Practice 96

> “He **pointed to** the chart.”

「他指向圖表。」

point = 用手指、手或物件指示某個方向 / 對象

49. **point at (指著) — 指向 ; 用手指著**

Practice 97

> “Don’t **point at** people.”

「不要用手**指著別人**。」

Practice 98

> “She **pointed at** the number on the screen.”

「她**指著**螢幕上的數字。」

point at = 把手指 / 物件直接朝向某個對象

Can sometimes sound socially impolite when done to a person.

50. **point to (指向 / 顯示) — 指向 ; 表明**

Literal and figurative.

Practice 99

> “The arrow **points to** the exit.”

「箭嘴**指向**出口。」

Practice 100

> “The evidence **points to** a different conclusion.”

「證據**指向 / 顯示**另一個結論。」

point to = 物理上指向某物 , 或比喻上提供證據令某個結論看來較可能

51. **point toward(s) (朝向 / 暗示) — 朝 ; 指向**

Practice 101

> “The sign **points toward** the main entrance.”

「標誌**指向**正門。」

Practice 102

> “The results **point toward** gradual improvement.”

「結果**顯示 / 指向**逐步改善的趨勢。」

point toward = 朝向某方向；或提供跡象支持某個發展 / 結論

52. **point something at someone/something** (把.....對準) — 指向；對準

Practice 103

> “She **pointed the remote at** the screen.”

「她把遙控器**對準**螢幕。」

Practice 104

> “He **pointed the camera at** the stage.”

「他把相機**對準**舞台。」

point object at X = 使物件的前端 / 作用方向對準某個目標

53. **point out** (指出) — 指出；提醒

A very important phrasal extension.

Practice 105

> “She **pointed out** a mistake in my slide.”

「她**指出**了投影片中的一個錯誤。」

Practice 106

> “I’d like to **point out** one important difference.”

「我想**指出**一個重要分別。」

point out = 特別引起別人注意某項資訊、事實或問題

54. **point out that... (指出.....) — 指出 ; 說明**

Practice 107

> “She **pointed out that** preparation matters.”

「她**指出**準備工作很重要。」

Practice 108

> “The report **points out that** the data is incomplete.”

「報告**指出**數據並不完整。」

point out that = 明確提出某個值得注意的事實 / 觀點

55. **point = aim/direct something (對準 / 指向) — 對準 ; 朝向**

Practice 109

> “Point the microphone toward your mouth.”

「把咪高峰**朝向 / 對準**你的嘴。」

Practice 110

> “The telescope was **pointed at** the sky.”

「望遠鏡**對準**天空。」

point something = 調整某物方向，使其朝向指定目標

56. **point = direct someone somewhere (指路) — 指示方向**

Practice 111

> “She **pointed me toward** the meeting room.”

「她**指示我往**會議室方向走。」

Practice 112

> “Could you **point me in the right direction**?”

「你可以**指點我正確方向**嗎？」

point someone toward/in direction = 為某人指出應該前往 / 採取的方向

Literal or figurative.

57. **point someone in the right direction (指點方向) — 給予初步指引**

A major idiom.

Practice 113

> “My supervisor **pointed me in the right direction**.”

「我的上司給了我**正確方向的指引**。」

Practice 114

> “I can’t solve it for you, but I can **point you in the right direction**.”

「我不能替你解決，但可以**給你一些正確方向的指引**。」

point someone in the right direction = 提供足夠提示 / 指引，讓對方知道應如何開始或繼續

58. **pointer = pointing device/indicator (指針 / 指示物) — 指針；指示器**

A related noun.

Practice 115

> “The **pointer** moved across the screen.”

「**指標 / 游標**在螢幕上移動。」

Practice 116

> “The gauge **pointer** showed the current level.”

「儀表的**指針**顯示目前水平。」

pointer = 用來指出位置、方向或數值的物件 / 圖示

59. **pointer** = useful tip (提示 / 建議) — 提示 ; 實用建議

A very common informal noun sense.

Practice 117

> “She gave me a few **pointers** before the presentation.”

「簡報前她給了我幾個**實用提示 / 建議**。」

Practice 118

> “Can you give me some **pointers** on public speaking?”

「你可以給我一些公開演講的**技巧提示**嗎？」

pointer = 幫助某人改善 / 學習某件事的簡短實用建議

60. **pointed** = having a sharp point (尖的) — 尖的 ; 尖頭的

A related adjective.

Practice 119

> “She wore **pointed** shoes.”

「她穿著**尖頭鞋**。」

Practice 120

> “The tool has a **pointed end**.”

「工具有一個**尖端**。」

****pointed = 末端逐漸收窄形成尖頭的****

61. ****pointed = deliberately direct/critical (尖銳 / 針對性的) — 尖銳的 ; 有針對性的****

A figurative adjective sense.

Practice 121

> “She asked a ****pointed question****.”

「她問了一條****尖銳而有針對性的問題****。」

Practice 122

> “He made a ****pointed remark**** about the delay.”

「他就延誤作出了一番****有針對性 / 尖銳的評論****。」

****pointed = 明顯有特定針對目標、常帶批評或強烈暗示的****

62. ****pointless (沒有意義 / 目的的) — 沒意義的 ; 徒勞的****

A major derivative.

Practice 123

> “Worrying about every tiny mistake is ****pointless****.”

「為每個小錯擔心是****沒有意義 / 沒有用的****。」

Practice 124

> “The argument became ****pointless****.”

「這場爭論變得****毫無意義****。」

****pointless = 沒有實際目的、價值或有用結果的****

This derives from:

> point = purpose

not from:

> point = dot.

63. **pointlessly** (毫無意義地) — 徒然地 ; 沒有目的地

Practice 125

> “They argued **pointlessly** for hours.”

「他們**毫無意義地**爭論了幾個小時。」

Practice 126

> “Don’t spend time worrying **pointlessly**.”

「不要**徒然地**花時間擔心。」

pointlessly = 以沒有實際目的 / 成果的方式

64. **point** = a unit in typography (點 ; 字級單位) — 點

A specialist but common publishing/design sense.

Practice 127

> “The body text is 12 **point**.”

「正文使用 12 **點字級**。」

Practice 128

> “Increase the font size by two **points**.”

「把字體大小增加兩**點**。」

point = 排版中衡量字體尺寸的一種單位

65. **point** = loyalty/reward unit (積分) — 積分

A modern commercial sense related to score units.

Practice 129

> “You earn ten **points** for every purchase.”

「每次購物可以賺取十個**積分**。」

Practice 130

> “I used my reward **points**.”

「我使用了自己的獎賞**積分**。」

points = 忠誠計劃 / 獎勵制度中累積和兌換的計量單位

66. **points** = arguments/items in a list (幾點事項) — 幾點 ; 事項

Practice 131

> “I have three **points** to discuss.”

「我有三個**要點 / 事項**要討論。」

Practice 132

> “Let’s review the main **points**.”

「我們重溫一下主要**要點**。」

points = 可逐項列出的想法、事項或內容

Important distinction: **point** vs **moment**

This is especially relevant to your passage.

moment

= a particular brief time.

point

= a position in time/process, often defined by what happens there.

Compare:

> “At that moment, I felt nervous.”

= 在那一刻，我很緊張。

> “At that point, I realized I had to change.”

= 到那個階段 / 時點，我意識到要改變。

****Point**** often emphasizes position in a sequence/development.

Important distinction: **turning point vs moment**

**moment**

simply identifies a time.

**turning point**

means:

> a time/event after which the direction of development changes significantly.

Not every memorable moment is a turning point.

Important distinction: **point vs stage**

**point**

can be a relatively exact position in development.

**stage**

usually means a broader phase lasting some time.

> “At this point, we need a decision.”

= 到這個時點。

> “At this stage of the project...”

= 在項目的這個階段。

They often overlap, but **stage** usually covers a larger span.

Important distinction: **point = idea vs point = purpose**

Compare:

> “I understand your point.”

= 我明白你的**意思 / 觀點**。

versus:

> “What’s the point of doing this?”

= 做這件事有甚麼**目的 / 意義**？

These are separate abstract branches.

Important distinction: **point vs idea**

idea

= thought/concept generally.

point

= specific idea that matters in an argument/discussion.

> “I have an idea.”

= 我有一個想法。

> “I have a point to make.”

= 我有一個要提出的重點 / 論點。

Important distinction: **point vs argument**

point

= one specific claim/reason within discussion.

argument

can mean:

- * a structured set of reasons supporting a conclusion;
- * a disagreement/quarrel.

A point may form part of an argument.

Important distinction: **make a point vs make a point of**

These are easily confused.

make a point

= state an idea/argument.

> “She made a good point.”

= 她提出了很有道理的一點。

make a point of doing

= deliberately ensure that you do something.

> “She makes a point of arriving early.”

= 她總會特意提早到。

The addition of **of** changes the meaning significantly.

Important distinction: **get the point vs get to the point**

get the point

= understand the meaning.

get to the point

= stop unnecessary detail and say the important thing.

> “I get your point.”

= 我明白你的意思。

> “Please get to the point.”

= 請直接說重點。

Important distinction: **to the point vs beside the point**

Near opposites.

to the point

= directly relevant and concise.

beside the point

= irrelevant to the real issue.

Important distinction: **no point in vs pointless**

These express almost the same idea in different grammar.

> “There’s no point in worrying.”

= 擔心沒有用。

> “Worrying is pointless.”

= 擔心是沒有意義的。

So:

pointless derives from **point = purpose/value**.

Important distinction: **point of view vs opinion**

opinion

= specific belief/view about something.

point of view

= broader perspective/position from which you understand it.

Two people may agree on one opinion while still having different broader points of view.

Important distinction: **point vs place**

place

= location or area generally.

point

= more exact/specific location.

> “Meet me at this place.”

broad.

> “Meet me at this point on the map.”

precise.

Important distinction: **point vs spot**

Both can mean a location.

point

often sounds more exact/abstract/map-like.

spot

often means a small physical place.

> meeting point

= 集合點

> picnic spot

= 野餐地點

Important distinction: **point at** vs **point to**

They overlap but often differ subtly.

point at

often emphasizes the physical act of aiming a finger/object directly at something.

> “He pointed at me.”

point to

can be physical, but is especially common figuratively:

> “The evidence points to a problem.”

So:

point at = 動作 / 目標

point to = 指向；亦常表示證據顯示

Important distinction: **point out** vs **point to**

point out

= deliberately draw attention to a fact.

> “She pointed out the mistake.”

= 她指出錯誤。

point to

= indicate, sometimes indirectly through evidence.

> “The figures point to slower growth.”

= 數據顯示增長放慢。

Important distinction: **point vs tip**

For physical objects:

point

= very sharp ending.

tip

= end part generally, which need not be extremely sharp.

> point of a needle

= 針尖

> tip of your finger

= 指尖

Important distinction: **point vs score**

score

can mean total/result:

> “The score was 20–18.”

point

is an individual scoring unit:

> “They won by two points.”

So points contribute to a score.

Important distinction: **percent vs percentage point**

This is an important numerical distinction.

If a rate changes:

> from 10% to 15%

the increase is:

> **5 percentage points**

but relative percentage increase is:

> **50 percent**

Therefore:

percentage point = 百分比之間的直接差距

percent change = 相對變化率

Important distinction: **pointed vs direct**

direct question

= straightforward, not indirect.

pointed question

= deliberately targeted, often designed to expose something or apply pressure.

A pointed question can sound sharper or more critical than merely direct.

Important distinction: **pointer vs point**

point

= idea/location/dot/etc.

pointer

can mean:

- * indicator;
- * device;
- * practical tip.

> “She gave me some pointers.”

= 她給了我一些實用建議。

Not:

> some points

though **points** can mean discussion items.

Family-extension sweep

The practical **point** family is exceptionally rich in stages, ideas, purposes, locations, measurement, scoring, and direction:

- * **point — moment/stage** = 時點 / 階段
- * **turning point** = 轉捩點
- * **point in time** = 時間點
- * **at this/that point** = 到這 / 那個時候
- * **reach a point where** = 到達某階段
- * **to the point where** = 到了某程度
- * **point — main idea** = 重點 / 要點
- * **main/key point** = 主要 / 關鍵重點
- * **make a point** = 提出觀點
- * **make the point that** = 指出 / 強調
- * **get the point** = 明白意思
- * **miss the point** = 沒抓住重點
- * **get to the point** = 直入重點
- * **to the point** = 切中要點
- * **beside the point** = 與重點無關
- * **point — purpose** = 目的 / 意義
- * **what’s the point?** = 有甚麼意義？
- * **no point in doing** = 做……沒有用
- * **have a point** = 說得有道理
- * **point taken** = 明白 / 接受這一點

* **prove a point** = 證明觀點
* **make a point of doing** = 特意做
* **point of view** = 觀點 / 角度
* **viewpoint** = 觀點 / 立場
* **point — location** = 精確位置
* **starting/end/meeting point** = 起點 / 終點 / 集合點
* **point — dot** = 點
* **data point** = 數據點
* **point — sharp tip** = 尖端
* **point — score** = 分數單位
* **percentage point** = 百分點
* **decimal point** = 小數點
* **boiling/freezing/melting point** = 沸點 / 冰點 / 熔點
* **breaking point** = 承受極限
* **strong/weak point** = 強項 / 弱點
* **selling point** = 賣點
* **point — verb** = 指向
* **point at** = 指著
* **point to** = 指向 / 顯示
* **point toward** = 朝向 / 暗示
* **point out** = 指出
* **point someone in the right direction** = 給予方向 / 指引
* **pointer — indicator** = 指針 / 指示器
* **pointer — advice** = 實用提示
* **pointed — sharp** = 尖頭的
* **pointed — targeted** = 尖銳 / 有針對性的
* **pointless** = 沒有意義 /